Rahel **Zimmermann**

ENVIRONMENTAL LAWYER, DOCTORAL STUDENT

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Professional Experience

Environmental Lawyer — *Wallisellen, CH*

ECOSENS AG — *Nov. 2020 - date*

- Advising clients on diverse matters of environmental law (contaminated site and waste law, water protection law, climate law, etc.)
- Representing clients before authorities and courts in written proceedings
- Writing legal opinions for cantonal authorities, the Federal Office for the Environment, and private clients on emerging environmental law issues, such as the regulatory admissibility of certain Carbon Capture and Storage (CCS) technologies, and the application of the polluter-pays principle to PFAS-contaminated sites

Graduate intern, Law and Information Protection — *Berne, CH*

GENERAL SECRETARIAT, FEDERAL DEPARTEMENT OF ECONOMIC AFFAIRS, EDUCATION AND RESEARCH — *Oct. 2019 - Oct. 2020*

- Examining office consultations, preparing briefing notes and recommendations for Federal Councilor Guy Parmelin, and participating in meetings with his advisors
- Drafting summary penalty orders in administrative criminal proceedings regarding wood and fur declaration obligations
- Support to the investigator-in-charge in an administrative investigation in the Federal Office for National Economic Supply

Legal associate (part-time) — *Lucerne, CH*

BUCHER TAX AG — *Febr. 2017 - Sept. 2019*

- Communication with clients, filling out tax returns and making tax calculations
- Writing blog articles on national and international tax issues such as the OECD/G20 BEPS Project and the taxation of cryptocurrencies
- Administration of social media and web channels, organisation of webinars and other marketing activities

Other (part-time) experience — *Basel, Geneva, Lucerne, Zurich, CH*

DETAILED INFORMATION AVAILABLE UPON REQUEST — *2011 - 2018*

- Intern at Newscast "Tagesschau", Swiss TV (SRF)
- Assistance in the organisation and realisation of events (e.g. OSCE ministerial council meeting 2014 in Basel)
- Accounting and diverse administrative tasks
- Brand promotion and work in the hospitality field

Education

Doctorate | International Environmental Law — *Geneva, CH*

UNIVERSITY OF GENEVA — *Sept. 2021 - date*

- Doctoral thesis by monograph under the supervision of Prof. Makane Moïse Mbengue
- Title: "Learning to Dance with the Earth System: A Proposal to Move International Environmental Law into a New Era"
- Visiting Scholarship from March-May 2025 at the Copernicus Institute of Sustainable Development (Utrecht University) with Dr. Rakhyun E. Kim

MLaw & BLaw | Focus in International Law — *Lucerne, CH*

UNIVERSITY OF LUCERNE — *Sept. 2016 - Jan. 2020*

- Master thesis: "The World Health Organization as actor in international environmental law? An analysis by example of the global waste challenge" written under the supervision of Prof. Thilo Marauhn which received the heighest grade
- Bachelor thesis in (international) tax law on controlled foreign companies (CFC) rules at the intersection of the EU, the OECD and Switzerland, which also received the heighest grade

BA in International Relations | Law & Political Sciences tracks — *Geneva, CH*

UNIVERSITY OF GENEVA — *Sept. 2012 - Sept. 2015*

- Bachelor thesis under the supervision of Prof. Robert Kolb on "The applicability of international humanitarian law to cyber attacks – an analysis by example of the Stuxnet case" (marked *Excellent*)

Skills

Languages

German:	Native
English:	Cambridge Certificate of Proficiency (C2)
French:	Diplôme approfondi de langue française (C2)
Spanish:	Diploma de español como lengua extranjera (B1)

IT MS Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint), Homepagetools like Jimdo, Drupal or Typo3, LaTeX,GitHub, Mailchimp, Fabasoft, Acta Nova, Facebook Targeted Advertising, LinkedIn

Teaching Experience

University of Berne, Master of Law Course "Environmental Law" — *Berne, CH*

Contaminated sites law — *Nov. 2025*

Swissmem (Association of the Swiss technology industry), Basis course for environmental managers — *Zurich, CH*

Environmental law — *Sept. 2024 - date*

VZGV (Association of Zurich Municipal and Administrative Professionals), Continuing education course for professionals of building and planning authorities — *Zurich, CH*

Environmental law — *Sept. 2024 - date*

University of Berne, Training for contaminated site specialists — *Berne, CH*

Contaminated sites law — *June 2022 - date*

Hochschule für Wirtschaft Zürich, MAS Real Estate Management — *Zurich, CH*

Sustainability in the real estate industry — *Dec. 2021 - date*

Other activities, affiliations & degrees

Earth System Governance Project

Research Fellow — *March 2026 - date*

- Presentation of my doctoral research at the Earth System Law Symposium in Nov. 2025, panelist at the closing podium discussion, and participation at the author workshop "Exploring New Frontiers in Earth System Law: From Theory to Practice"
- Mentee in the 2024 Earth System Governance Mentoring Initiative (Mentor: Dr. Rakhyun E. Kim)
- Member of the Earth System Law Taskforce and regular participation at their meetings since Oct. 2023

Fachgruppe Umwelt

Member — *Dec. 2024 - date*

- Participation in bi-monthly meetings, dissemination and experience exchange among environmental lawyers

Verein zur Förderung der Berufsausbildung im Bereich Musical und Show

President — *Dec. 2023 - date*

- Non-profit association dedicated to promoting professional training in musical theatre and show, with a focus on supporting talented students from financially disadvantaged backgrounds, funding training infrastructure, and enabling non-profit school and graduation productions
- My activities as president include strategic coordination, marketing, fundraising, development of partnerships, preparing grant applications to foundations, reviewing scholarship applications, and managing communication with public authroities and scholarhsip recipients

IUCN World Commission on Environmental Law (WCEL)

Soil and Sustainable Agriculture Law, Climate Change Law, Early Career Specialist Groups (Member) — *Sept. 2023 - date*

- Presenting research at conferences (e.g., IUCN WCEL 4th International Environmental Law Congress in Rabat, 20th Annual Colloquium of the IUCN Academy of Environmental Law in Joensuu)
- Contributed to drafting Motion 007 on Soil Security Law and helped secure co-sponsors and votes for the IUCN World Conservation Congress 2025 in Abu Dhabi
- Part of the Global Legal Instrument on Soil Security (GLISS) Sub-Working Group of the Soil and Sustainable Agriculture Law Specialist Group

Swiss Society of International Law (SVIR SSDI)

Expert Group "Law & Sustainable Development" (Member) — *Feb. 2023 - date*

- Part of the author team for the book project "Sustainable Development in Swiss Law"
- Participation at author workshops, conferences and book launch

Vereinigung für Umweltrecht (VUR)

Member — *Oct. 2022 - date*

- Participation at conferences and publication of article in association's expert journal

Foundation Certificate in Musical Theatre

Institute of the Arts Barcelona — *Sept. 2015 - May 2016*

- Gap year certification with focus on dance, singing and acting

Publications

Understanding of sustainability in environmental law and its implementation deficits – illustrated by the example of contaminated sites law (GER)

C. Sieber-Gasser, E. Bürgi Bonanomi and R. Koch (eds.), Sustainable Development in Swiss Law

2025, Stämpfli Verlag

Carbon capture and storage technologies in Switzerland: New legal developments and their gaps (GER)

Umweltrecht in der Praxis (URP)

2023, URP 2023-5

Enforcement aid for determining the obligations to carry out investigation, monitoring and remediation measures, to bear the costs, and to provide security under contaminated sites law (GER, FR, IT)

Federal Office for the Environment (FOEN)

2023, https://www.bafu.admin.ch/de/vollzugshilfen-altlasten

The World Health Organization as actor in international environmental law? An analysis by example of the global waste challenge (EN)

Review of European, Comparative and International Environmental Law (RECIEL)

2021, DOI: 10.1111/reel.12415

References

References are available upon request